

INTERNATIONAL news

US exempts smartphones, electronics from reciprocal tariffs

The US government excluded smartphones, computers, and electronics from reciprocal tariffs, protecting consumers from price hikes and benefiting tech giants like Apple and Samsung. The exemption, announced by US Customs and Border Protection, also covers semiconductors, solar cells, and memory cards. This move narrows the scope of former President Trump's trade levies.

China demands full reciprocal tariff repeal from the US

Amid escalating US-China trade tensions, China urged a full rollback of US tariffs after limited tech product exemptions, calling them inadequate. Most Chinese exports still face steep duties, while Beijing imposed retaliatory tariffs on US goods. China's commerce ministry stressed the need for mutual respect and broader action to repair strained trade ties and stabilise markets.

US targets 50+ Chinese firms to control AI advancements

The US has blacklisted over 50 Chinese companies to curb Beijing's advancements in AI and high-performance computing. The action restricts American firms from supplying these entities, citing national security risks. Targeted companies are linked to military tech and AI developments. China condemned the move, escalating tensions in the ongoing US-China tech rivalry.

Malaysia tightens semiconductor rules amid US pressure on China

Malaysia has tightened semiconductor regulations under US pressure to prevent AI chips, especially from Nvidia, from reaching China. This follows concerns over Chinese firm DeepSeek's potential use of banned chips. The US is investigating fraud cases linked to the shipment of advanced chips, while tensions between the US and China over AI technology intensify.



Taiwan to assess US chip tariffs and urges fair talks

Taiwan is preparing to counter potential US semiconductor tariffs by assessing their impact and initiating talks with Washington. Economy Minister Kuo Jyh-huei highlighted fair competition for Taiwan's chip sector amid growing trade tensions. Taiwan, led by TSMC, remains a key supplier to the US and aims for balanced treatment in ongoing discussions.

Nvidia invests \$500 billion in US AI infrastructure

Nvidia has decided to invest up to \$500 billion over four years to produce AI chips in the US, shifting from Taiwan. Partnering with TSMC, Foxconn, and others, the move will expand AI infrastructure, create thousands of jobs, and strengthen supply chains. It supports US efforts to reshore tech manufacturing and meet rising global demand for AI.

Infineon acquires Marvell's Ethernet business for \$2.5 billion

German chip giant Infineon is acquiring Marvell's automotive Ethernet business for \$2.5 billion to boost its software-defined vehicle (SDV) capabilities. The deal strengthens Infineon's automotive semiconductor dominance and expansion into AI and humanoid robotics. Marvell will refocus on data centres, while Infineon aims to integrate Ethernet tech into its portfolio, targeting long-term growth.

Samsung forecasts 1Q25 profit drop amid chip woes and market struggles

Samsung Electronics faced a 21% drop in Q1 profit, primarily due to weak AI chip demand and losses in its foundry business. Despite rising smartphone shipments, declining chip prices and stiff competition from SK Hynix, which benefits from AI chip demand, have hampered performance. Additionally, tariffs and reduced Chinese demand for AI chips pressure the Korean tech giant.

Google in talks to rent Nvidia Blackwell GPUs from CoreWeave

Google has been in talks to rent Nvidia's Blackwell GPUs from CoreWeave, as demand for AI chips outpaces supply. Struggling with shortages, Google plans to boost its AI infrastructure with a \$75 billion capital expenditure by 2025. The deal, smaller than Microsoft's or OpenAI's, could expand, with Google also considering leasing space in CoreWeave's data centres.

Schneider Electric boosts US operations with \$700 million investment

France's Schneider Electric would be investing \$700 million across eight US states by 2027 to expand data centres and energy infrastructure, aiming to create over 1000 jobs. The investment supports the growing demand for AI and energy solutions. This is part of a broader \$1 billion initiative to boost local production and mitigate tariff impacts.

UK government endorses Vishay's £250 million fab venture in Newport

The UK government has approved Vishay Intertechnology's £250 million investment in the Newport Wafer Fab, South Wales, to boost silicon carbide production for EV technology. The project will create over 500 jobs and support the UK's goal of expanding semiconductor manufacturing.

Qualcomm accuses ARM of stifling competition and files complaints

Qualcomm has filed global antitrust complaints against ARM, accusing it of limiting access to its technology and stifling competition by changing its licensing model. Qualcomm claims this harms the chip industry, while ARM denies the allegations, calling them a 'desperate attempt' amid their commercial dispute. Both companies' stocks have seen declines recently.

SEMI, ESIA advocate for a stronger EU semiconductor future

SEMI and the European Semiconductor Industry Association (ESIA) are urging more R&D funding and a stronger European semiconductor strategy following the 2023 EU Chips Act. At a European Parliament roundtable, political leaders emphasised boosting technological capabilities, accelerating innovation, and strengthening global competitiveness. Members called for follow-up actions, including new funding and policy revisions.